

Title: Digital Budgeting Habits and Financial Decision-Making Among Graduate Students

Background of the Study

Financial management is an important skill for students, especially those who balance tuition fees, daily expenses, transportation costs, family responsibilities, and personal savings. Many graduate students already use digital finance tools such as mobile banking applications, e-wallets, online spreadsheets, and budgeting applications. However, the use of these tools does not always guarantee better financial decisions. Some students may track expenses regularly, while others may only use digital tools for payment transactions without monitoring their spending behavior.

This study aims to understand how digital budgeting habits influence the financial decision-making of graduate students. It focuses on whether students who use digital budgeting tools are more aware of their spending patterns, more likely to save, and more capable of planning for academic and personal expenses. The topic is relevant because financial stress can affect academic performance, motivation, and overall well-being.

Statement of the Problem

The main problem addressed by this study is the lack of clear understanding of how digital budgeting practices affect the financial decisions of graduate students. While many students use digital payment platforms, not all students use them for budgeting, expense tracking, or financial planning. This creates a gap between access to financial technology and actual financial discipline.

Research Objectives

This study aims to:

1. Identify the digital budgeting tools commonly used by graduate students.
2. Determine the frequency of digital budgeting and expense tracking among graduate students.
3. Assess how digital budgeting habits affect spending, saving, and financial planning.
4. Identify challenges experienced by students when using digital budgeting tools.
5. Recommend ways to improve student financial awareness through digital tools.

Proposed Methodology

This study will use a descriptive quantitative research design. A survey questionnaire will be distributed to selected graduate students. The questionnaire will include questions about their use of mobile banking, e-wallets, budgeting applications, spreadsheets, and other digital financial tools. It will also ask about their spending habits, saving behavior, and financial planning practices.

The data will be analyzed using descriptive statistics such as frequency, percentage, mean, and ranking. The study may also compare the financial decision-making behavior of students who regularly use budgeting tools and those who do not.

Expected Output

The expected output of this study is a summary of how graduate students use digital budgeting tools and how these tools influence their financial behavior. The study may also produce recommendations for promoting better financial literacy and responsible use of financial technology among students.

Significance of the Study

This study may benefit graduate students by helping them become more aware of their financial habits. It may also help schools design financial literacy programs that are more relevant to students who already use digital tools. The findings may also guide administrators in creating support programs related to budgeting, savings, and financial planning.

Keywords

Digital budgeting, financial technology, financial literacy, graduate students, mobile banking, e-wallets, expense tracking, savings behavior, financial decision-making, student finance